

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

regardless of our income schedule, major bills tend to be paid on a monthly basis. You might choose to do yours on paper, on an Excel spreadsheet or using an app, depending on what works for you, but there are a few things that your budget should be, regardless of the format.

A successful budget is:

- Easy to follow (don't give columns weird labels)
- At least a little flexible (if the Eiffel Tower didn't bend a little in the wind, it would break)
- Comprehensive (don't leave any payments or accounts out)
- Accurate (don't guess or round amounts down)

You might also choose to keep expenses in your budget, especially if you use an app that links to your bank account or a Google sheet that lives on your phone, so you can add things as you go. This is great for staying accountable and reducing 'sleep-spending' throughout the month, but can be anxiety-inducing if your issues with money revolve around needing to control every last penny and struggling to let go. This is completely up to you, but what I'd like you to do now is make your budget, or revisit an abandoned one, and look at what you need to change to make it work for you.

As you start to build your budget, carefully considering your priorities and what you feel are reasonable amounts to allocate